

Eleanor Roosevelt

The social CAMPAIGNER who is one of the most influential women of the 20th century

All about me

- BORN: 1884
- DIED: 1962
- NATIONALITY: American
- FACTOID: My husband was President of the United States.
- IN A NUTSHELL: At 15, I was sent to finishing school near London, England, where my headmistress taught me the importance of independent thinking.

A first lady with a heart

Eleanor's husband, Franklin, was America's President from 1933 to 1945. During this time, she discussed her concerns and opinions in a **newspaper column**. She helped to create the **NATIONAL YOUTH ADMINISTRATION (NYA)**, which helped young people—male and female—get training. During the Second World War she helped gather civilian volunteers and **visited American troops abroad**.

Eleanor wrote her popular newspaper column, "My Day," from 1935 to 1962.

By the way... people wanted me to run for Vice President with President Truman in 1948, but I wasn't interested.

Eleanor with the members of the Commission on Human Rights in 1946.

The UN ambassador

In 1946, Eleanor became the first chairperson of the **United Nations (UN) Human Rights Commission**. Two years later, she helped create the "**UNIVERSAL DECLARATION OF HUMAN RIGHTS**," which stated that everyone was entitled to the same freedoms and rights. She also supported the foundation of the State of Israel, and tried to **open negotiations** with the Soviet Union during the Cold War, a time of great political hostility between the Soviet Union and the United States.

